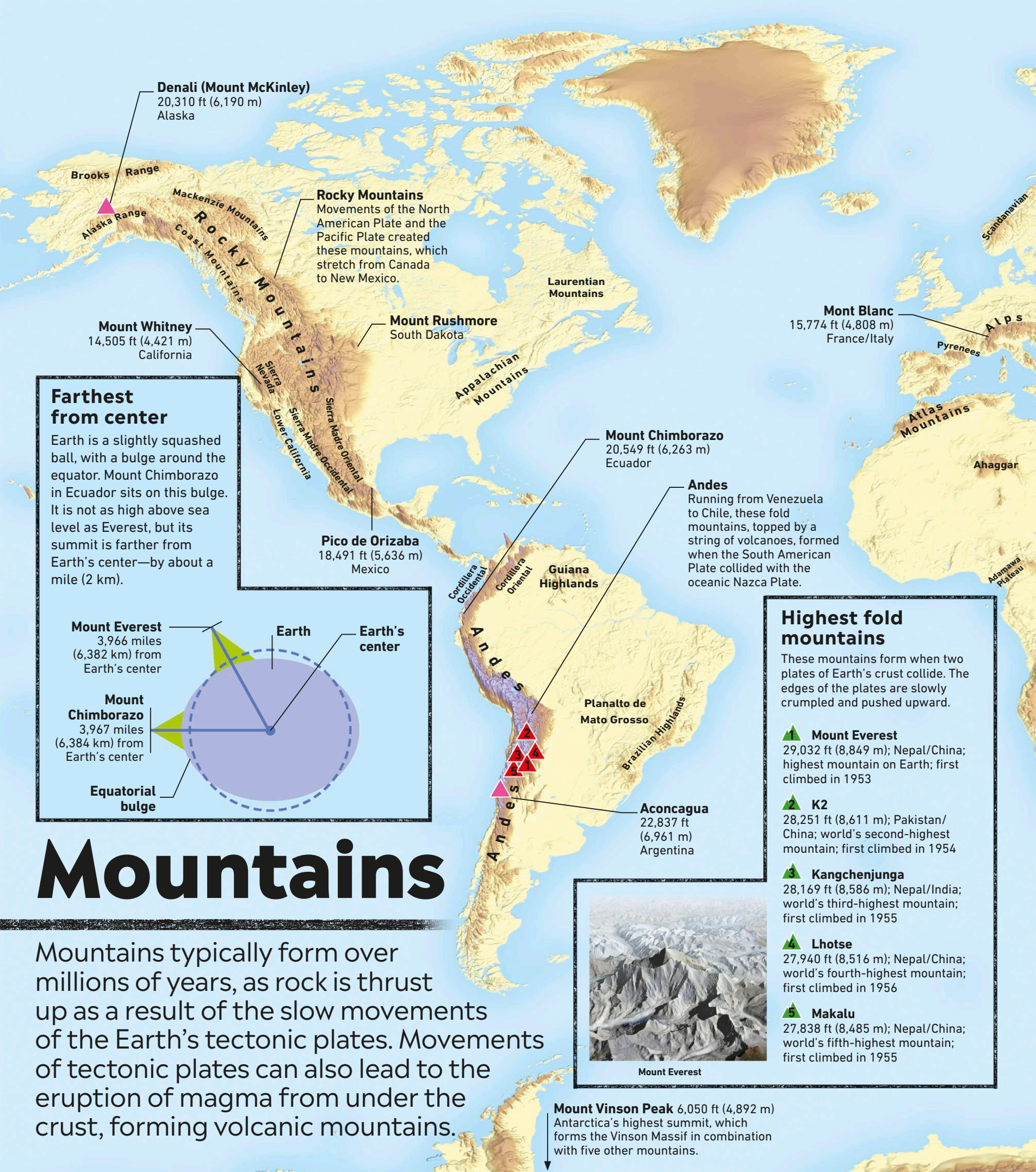




Farthest from center

Earth is a slightly squashed ball, with a bulge around the equator. Mount Chimborazo in Ecuador sits on this bulge. It is not as high above sea level as Everest, but its summit is farther from Earth's center—by about a mile (2 km).

Mount Everest
3,966 miles
(6,382 km) from
Earth's center

Mount Chimborazo
3,967 miles
(6,384 km) from
Earth's center

Equatorial bulge

Mountains

Mountains typically form over millions of years, as rock is thrust up as a result of the slow movements of the Earth's tectonic plates. Movements of tectonic plates can also lead to the eruption of magma from under the crust, forming volcanic mountains.

Mount Chimborazo
20,549 ft (6,263 m)
Ecuador

Andes
Running from Venezuela to Chile, these fold mountains, topped by a string of volcanoes, formed when the South American Plate collided with the oceanic Nazca Plate.

Highest fold mountains

These mountains form when two plates of Earth's crust collide. The edges of the plates are slowly crumpled and pushed upward.

1 Mount Everest
29,032 ft (8,849 m); Nepal/China; highest mountain on Earth; first climbed in 1953

2 K2
28,251 ft (8,611 m); Pakistan/China; world's second-highest mountain; first climbed in 1954

3 Kangchenjunga
28,169 ft (8,586 m); Nepal/India; world's third-highest mountain; first climbed in 1955

4 Lhotse
27,940 ft (8,516 m); Nepal/China; world's fourth-highest mountain; first climbed in 1956

5 Makalu
27,838 ft (8,485 m); Nepal/China; world's fifth-highest mountain; first climbed in 1955



Mount Everest

Mount Vinson Peak 6,050 ft (4,892 m)
Antarctica's highest summit, which forms the Vinson Massif in combination with five other mountains.